

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp

TUESDAY, AUGUST 25, 2026 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVIII NO. 47

WSJ.com

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DJIA 53417.16 ▲ 140.15 0.26% NASDAQ 25980.19 ▼ 0.8% STOXX 600 654.21 ▲ 0.005% 10-YR. TREAS. ▲ 8/32, yield 4.703% OIL \$85.01 ▼ \$2.05 GOLD \$4,640.80 ▲ \$16.70 EURO \$1.1664 YEN 159.10

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **California canceled** a planned meeting with Paramount's chief executive where the parties were expected to discuss settling a lawsuit blocking the company's acquisition of Warner Bros. Discovery. **B1**
- ◆ **Sliding shares of** chip makers and intensifying geopolitical tension weighed on tech-heavy U.S. stock indexes, helping depress the S&P 500 and Nasdaq by 0.3% and 0.8%, respectively. The Dow rose 0.3%. **B9**
- ◆ **Two months after** China-owned electric-vehicle maker Polestar was forced to leave the U.S. market, the company told its American dealers that it was blindsided by the decision. **B1**
- ◆ **The NHTSA** expanded its investigation into GM's electronic braking system after receiving several complaints. **B2**
- ◆ **SoftBank plans** to issue a record volume of retail bonds to partly fund its expanding artificial-intelligence investments. **B3**
- ◆ **Eli Lilly launched** its Founday weight-loss pill in the U.K., making the country the first in Europe to offer the oral treatment. **B3**
- ◆ **PDD, the Chinese** owner of bargain-shopping app Temu, reported better-than-expected profit for the second quarter. **B3**
- ◆ **The FTC reached** a settlement with Zillow and Redfin, resolving a claim that the companies had collaborated to reduce market competition. **B4**
- ◆ **YMTC, China's flagship** memory-chip maker, filed for an IPO in Shanghai to raise \$4.9 billion, potentially leading to a boost in the company's output. **B4**

Worldwide

- ◆ **Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent** said the U.S. is launching a new campaign to isolate Iran, warning of consequences for nations and companies that do business with the regime. **A1**
- ◆ **The trackers** whose job it is to count the world's oil shipments see much less volume passing through the Strait of Hormuz than that publicized by the Trump administration. **A1**
- ◆ **Trump said the U.S.** would impose 50% tariffs on automobiles and parts from Canada starting in January, escalating a tit-for-tat trade conflict that erupted days ago. **A1, A2**
- ◆ **The Supreme Court** removed a legal obstacle that had stopped the president from imposing new restrictions on mail-in voting ahead of the midterm elections in November. **A3**
- ◆ **The U.S. scrapped** a large-scale amphibious exercise with South Korea scheduled for next month, the latest American pullback in Asia amid the war in Iran. **A6**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** proposed a revised six-figure fee for H-1B visas that would apply to most new applicants, replacing a plan to charge \$100,000 for the document that courts struck down. **A2**

- ◆ **The U.K. and France** are sending classified technology to Kyiv to allow it to make an Anglo-French cruise missile that it can field in the war with Russia. **A5**
- ◆ **Taiwan prosecutors** charged nine people, including former employees of Nvidia and Super Micro, with aiding the shipment of advanced AI servers to China. **A6**

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Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent on Monday said the U.S. would start a new campaign of economic measures against Iran and countries doing business with the regime. Top Iranian officials said the new U.S. strategy would be ineffective.

Oil Math Doesn't Add Up In Hormuz

DUBAI—The Trump administration says large volumes of oil are slipping through the Strait of Hormuz. The trackers whose job it is to count the world's oil shipments see much less.

By Georgi Kantchev, Rebecca Feng and Summer Said

Energy Secretary Chris Wright said last week the U.S. military had helped ship over 15 million barrels of crude and oil products out of the waterway last week. He put the average oil exports through the strait over a seven-day period at more than 8 million barrels a day. Earlier this month, Wright said the seven-day average stood at around 9 million barrels a day.

The count from commercial ship trackers tells a different story, with estimates ranging from 2 million to 6 million barrels a day. Industry figures on the amount of crude oil and oil products being loaded onto ships in the Persian Gulf and delivered to buyers don't corroborate the U.S. claims.

The discrepancy matters in terms of setting expectations for oil traders and for judging who is winning the economic war of attrition that Washington and Tehran are fighting, with oil as a key weapon.

There are lots of reasons the numbers can diverge. Many ships are crossing the strait at night with their transmitters off.

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U.S. Launches New Wave Of Sanctions Against Iran

WASHINGTON—Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said on Monday the U.S. is launching a new campaign to isolate the Iranian regime, warning that countries and companies that do business with Tehran will face the wrath of the Trump administration.

By Brian Schwartz, Laurence Norman and Alexander Ward

"Let there be no ambiguity as to the position of the United States: An economic engagement of any kind with this murderous regime will

expose those responsible to the full reach of American power," Bessent said during a news conference.

As part of the new effort, which he called "Operation Economic Outcast," Bessent said his department has "mapped every node, every facilitator and every network that Iran has used to smuggle oil and evade sanctions." He said the U.S. was sanctioning more than 60 entities, individuals and vessels across the world that enable the regime to procure nuclear and missile technology, earn revenue from oil and carry out

cyber operations.

The U.S. has had sanctions on Iran for years, but the Trump administration's recent naval blockade against Iranian ports and commerce is adding pressure to Tehran's weak economy. With Iran's currency recently dropping to a record low against the dollar, President Trump said on social media Monday that Iran is "completely collapsing."

Top Iranian officials said the new effort would be ineffective.

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◆ **AI jitters, trade threats** pressure stocks..... **B9**

How the President Got the DOJ Off Live Nation's Back

Antitrust case settled after White House call, avoiding breakup

The Justice Department was preparing to wage a legal battle more than a decade in the making against the world's largest concert promoter. Then President Trump called.

By Rebecca Ballhaus, Joe Palazzolo, Dana Mattioli, Josh Dawsey and Dave Michaels

Settle it, the president told a senior DOJ official, the official later told associates.

The intervention was bizarre. The antitrust trial against Live Nation—which also owns Ticketmaster, a combination that draws relentless consumer criticism—was set to begin March 2, just days away. Trump had vowed to crack down on the industry just a year earlier when he signed an executive order targeting

ticket-scalping and exploitative pricing. DOJ officials and the company had spent months exchanging settlement proposals but had little to show for it, and some in the government had been pushing to break up the giant.

White House involvement in law-enforcement matters, once taboo, is a regular feature of Trump's second term. But many DOJ officials regarded the political interference in the Live Nation case as extreme even for an administration in which the president has openly pressured law-enforcement officials to pursue perceived enemies and pardoned allies.

Weeks before Trump's call, Live Nation told DOJ officials that the company had brought in a fresh set of lawyers for settlement talks. They were from Sullivan & Cromwell, the New York City law firm.

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Trump Escalates Threats Against Canada

Tariffs on autos and parts are the latest in growing trade battle between neighbors

President Trump said the U.S. would impose 50% tariffs on automobiles and parts from Canada starting in January, the latest escalation in a tit-for-tat trade conflict that erupted over the weekend.

By Gavin Bade, Amanda Coletta and Paul Vieira

"On January First, 2027, Tariffs on all Cars, Trucks, both large and small, Automotive Parts, and Steel, will be increased to 50%," Trump wrote Monday on Truth Social. U.S. tariffs on Canadian automobiles now stand at 25%, with discounts for the U.S. content in cars, while steel tariffs are at 50%.

The threat came after Prime Minister Mark Carney of Canada said his government would respond to a separate set of Trump's tariffs with levies on U.S. products. Trump imposed those new tariffs—effective on about 5% of Canadian exports to the U.S.—early on Saturday, after last-minute talks fell apart.

Trump's latest move heightens the risk the U.S. and Canada could descend into all-out economic conflict. After talks collapsed, Carney said that his country would respond to Trump's actions and that he would rather have no economic deal with the U.S. than one he thought was bad for Canadian businesses or gave away its sovereignty.

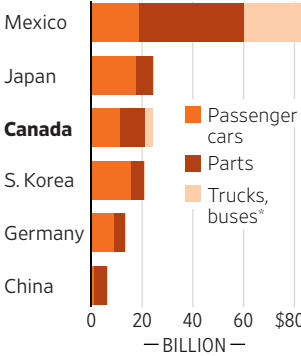
The new levies also cast further doubt over the future of the U.S.-Mexico-Canada Agreement, the trilateral deal that replaced Nafta.

Carney said on Monday it would be a "disappointment" if the deal collapsed.

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◆ **What's getting hit with the new tariffs**..... **A2**

U.S. imports of motor vehicles and parts in 2026 from select countries, through June



*Includes special purpose vehicles
Source: U.S. Census Bureau

Financier's Most Distressed Asset: A Seafood Shack in the Hamptons

Apollo Chief Marc Rowan's Montauk spot is at the center of an endless legal feud

By ERIN MULVANEY

MONTAUK, N.Y.—For a dozen years, Apollo Global Management CEO Marc Rowan has operated a side gig in Montauk: a seafood shack that draws celebrities and influencers with sunset views, Dom Pérignon and a \$97 lobster salad.

Just don't call it a restaurant in front of the neighbors. Many of them say it shouldn't be there at all.

They contend the business, known as Duryea's Lobster Deck, has never gone through the proper approval process. "Money and power should not

exempt you from the same laws that we have to follow," said Hannah Kirschner, who's had a home nearby since 1994.

Dating back to the 1920s, the property served as a rustic bait shop. The previous owner began to expand in the 1990s, adding picnic tables and a larger deck. Amid complaints from residents, the East Hampton Zoning Board found that a full-scale restaurant wasn't permitted, and prohibited any expansion without obtaining approvals from the town.

By the time Rowan bought the place in 2014, he inherited a messy legal situation.

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INSIDE



U.S. NEWS
Supreme Court ruling on mail-in voting is a win for Trump. **A3**



PERSONAL JOURNAL
Readers offer advice for a recently widowed traveler. **A10**

CEOs Want AI Agents To Read Your Messages

By LINDSAY ELLIS AND ALLISON POHLE

Lobbing a private Slack direct message to a colleague is second nature to many in the workplace—to brainstorm, plot strategy or even just vent. Artificial-intelligence creep is changing all that.

Executives are urging their staff to send messages in public Slack channels, open to anyone in the office to see, rather than privately pinging colleagues. They want AI agents crawling through messages to have unfettered access to every update on products, earnings and strategic initiatives.

As bots are unleashed throughout workplaces to analyze information, make recommendations, pull together slide decks or write code, the thinking goes, those AI agents should know the very latest

information available. After all, information is power. And while humans control most of it, bots are faster at gobbling it up and sifting through it.

Much of the focus on AI's impact on work has highlighted jobs—how corporate ladders will be structured and how staff might be reduced. Within companies, however, many leaders are examining how AI will change internal norms to deepen the technology's impact. Communication is one of them: Data on what people are writing and how they are working are becoming extremely valuable to companies.

"A big part of getting these agents to work really, really well is to make sure they have as much context as you can feed it," said Wade Foster, CEO and co-founder of Zapier, which automates repetitive tasks.

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